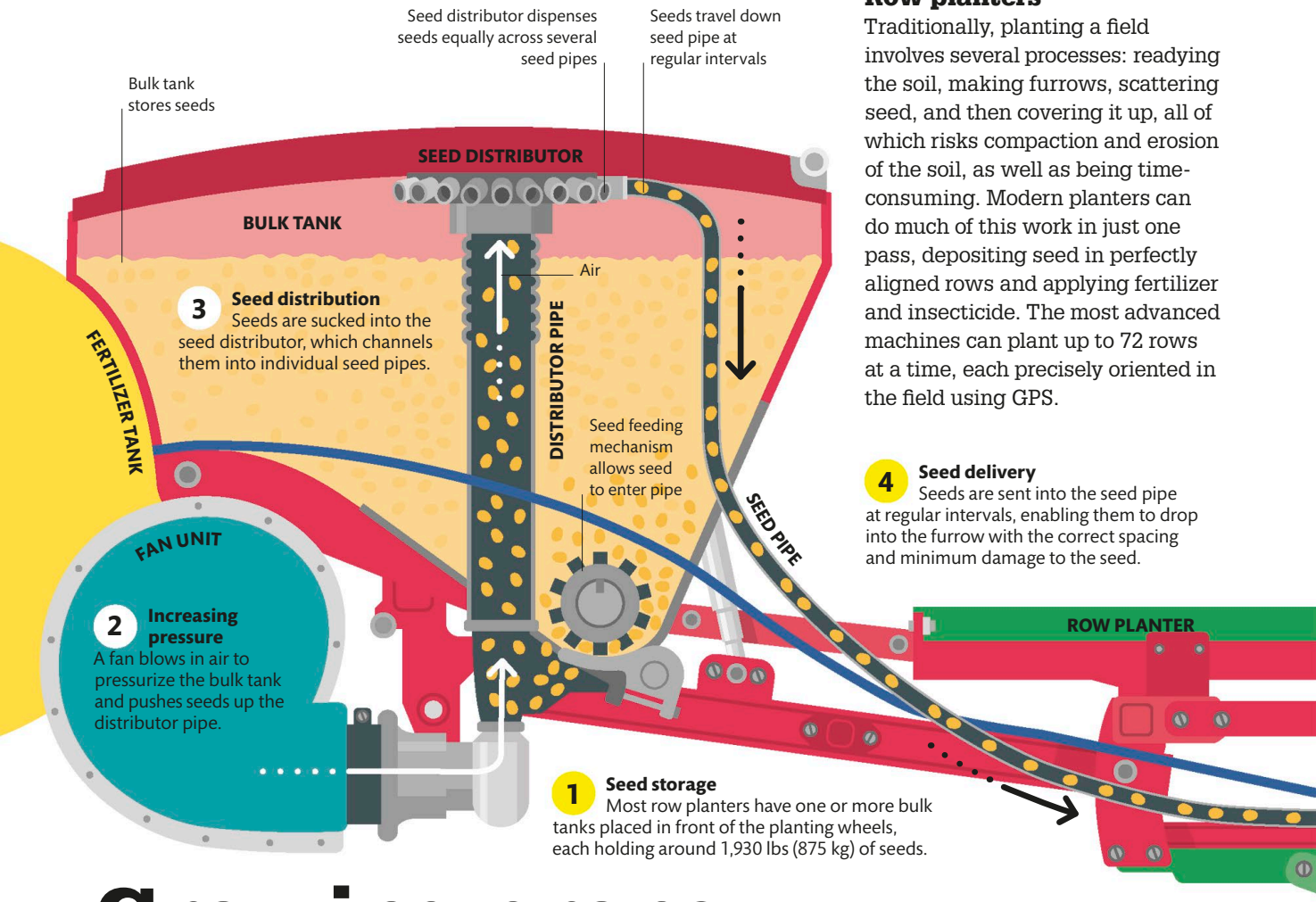
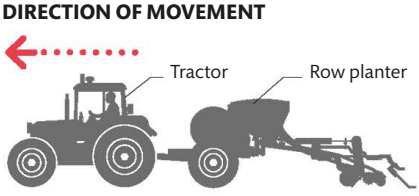


Row planters

Traditionally, planting a field involves several processes: readying the soil, making furrows, scattering seed, and then covering it up, all of which risks compaction and erosion of the soil, as well as being time-consuming. Modern planters can do much of this work in just one pass, depositing seed in perfectly aligned rows and applying fertilizer and insecticide. The most advanced machines can plant up to 72 rows at a time, each precisely oriented in the field using GPS.

Growing crops

Machines for planting seeds have existed for hundreds of years. However, modern planters have increased in size and capacity so that wide stretches of field can be covered in one sweep, vastly speeding up the time it takes to sow crops.





2.9 BILLION TONS (2.6 BILLION METRIC TONS)—THE TOTAL AMOUNT OF GRAIN PRODUCED IN THE WORLD EACH YEAR